

gained from the SBTIF. New York's economic development agency, Empire State Development, started this fund in the hopes to nurture all businesses based in technology. Read about this and other venture capital opportunities in New York here: www.nylovessmallbiz.com/growing_a_business/venture_capital.asp.

In a place like Rhode Island, Workforce Development is of great value. The Governor's Workforce Board knows just how important it is for employees of any business to possess the best skills and techniques. Great employees build great companies; it's a fact.

That is why the Governor's Workforce offers a series of grants to develop and train a team that will yield your business the best possible results. These Comprehensive Worker Training Grants can get you up to \$50,000 of free money! If a stronger workforce is what your company needs, then this grant will be of tremendous benefit. Learn more about it here: www.rihric.com/awards.htm.

Also, in case you didn't know, the agencies out there have tailored all kinds of programs to suit all kinds of people. If you are a woman, a minority, a veteran, or disabled, you have even more chances to get your hands on the free money!

If you have questions, and most new business owners do, you have free help waiting there as well. Many communities have agencies that offer free legal services. The Small Business Administration also offers legal advice.

Women Entrepreneurs

There are many terrific grant opportunities if you are of the female persuasion. The entire purpose of the Small Business Association's Office of Women's Business Ownership is to help women achieve their dreams and improve their communities by providing assistance for starting a business. They provide training on how to get started and how to maintain a successful business, and they offer plenty of help along the way. Check out the SBA's website for all the details (<http://www.sba.gov/aboutsba/sbaprograms/onlinewbc/index.html>).

Among the wonderful resources for women is SBA's Women Business Centers (WBC). Available for guidance every step of the way, this SBA